

FLAWLESS FIND

STRUTHIOMIMUS

The long tail on an ornithomimid such as *Struthiomimus* helped it balance its weight while running at high speed.

Complete dinosaur skeletons are rare.

Discovering a nearly intact one is cause for celebration because complete specimens reveal much more about a dinosaur and how it might have lived than partial fragments can. This

Struthiomimus skeleton is one of the most complete fossils ever found. *Struthiomimus* was an ornithomimid (a fast-moving, long-limbed theropod) that lived during the Late Cretaceous Period in what is now North America. This particular specimen was preserved in the “death pose,” with the animal’s neck bent back. Although many dinosaur fossils have been discovered in this pose, paleontologists are still unsure about the reasons for this strange position.

AT A GLANCE

- **YEAR OF DISCOVERY** 1914
- **PLACE** Alberta, Canada
- **FOUND BY** Barnum Brown
- **LIVED** 83–71 MYA



MR. BONES

The American paleontologist Barnum Brown was an extraordinary fossil hunter. Known as “Mr. Bones,” he collected hundreds of specimens, including this *Struthiomimus* fossil. Although he is credited for the discovery of numerous dinosaurs, his most important find was the first ever set of *Tyrannosaurus* bones in 1902.